

8.11 Educational attainment by sex and age

An analysis of educational attainment by age and sex given in table 8.10 reveals that the younger age groups have attained higher educational levels and also that the disparity in the educational attainments between males and females is less for the younger age groups. The relatively backward position of females in the higher age groups is related to factors in the historical development of educational facilities.

The proportion with no schooling which is 45 percent for persons aged 55 and over is seen to decline progressively with decreasing age. For the 45-54 age group it was 32.9 percent, for the 35-44 age group 27.5 percent and so on to 13.6 percent for the 15-19 group and 14.0 percent for the 10-14 group. This trend also reflects the improvement in the school attendance rate which has taken place with time.

The disparity between males and females with regard to non-schooling is also seen to be less for the younger compared to the older age groups. For the 55 and over age group 62.8 percent of the females and 30.4 percent of the males had no schooling. In the youngest age group i.e. the 10-14 group the percentage with no schooling was 12.8 for males and 15.4 for females. The proportions of males and females with no schooling as well as the difference between the proportions is seen to be considerably less in the younger age groups.

Considering the distribution of educational attainments within each age group it may be observed that above the age of 20, each age group shows an improvement in educational level over the immediately older group. For example larger proportions of the 45-54 group have attained higher levels of educational attainment than the 55 and over group. This is brought out more clearly by the percentages in each group of those who have completed primary and higher educational levels as shown below :

TABLE 8.10 : PERCENTAGE DISTRIBUTION OF PERSONS WHO HAVE COMPLETED PRIMARY AND HIGHER LEVELS, BY AGE GROUP

Age Group	Percentage completed primary and higher levels		
	Total	Male	Female
10-14	46.4	44.8	48.0
15-19	67.5	68.6	66.4
20-24	67.3	71.0	63.5
25-34	60.2	66.5	53.6
35-44	46.6	54.9	37.6
45-54	42.2	51.2	31.8
55 & Over	32.4	41.1	21.5

The proportion completing primary and higher levels increases steadily with decreasing age. Only 32.4 percent of the 55 and over group are in this category compared to 67.3 percent of the 20-24 group. The disparity between the proportions of males and females who have completed primary school and higher levels is also considerably much less for the younger age groups.

This indicates that males in general have a higher level of education than females.